TECH DIGEST PROJECT

Internet Law · LAW 575 · Spring 2027 · Professor Haque

Technology evolves faster than the institutions that regulate it. As a lawyer working where law meets technology, you will spend your whole career teaching yourself technical concepts nobody taught you in school, and then translating them for clients, judges, and colleagues. This project is three weeks of deliberate practice at exactly that, run at the start of the semester so its payoff compounds through every unit that follows.

Purpose: Why Are You Doing This?

- **Technical self-education.** Learn to independently research and understand technical concepts, the core skill of every technology lawyer.
- **Translation.** Practice turning tech speak into lay speak. The measure of your understanding is whether someone without it can follow you.
- **Better-medium literacy.** Text is not always the best teacher. Some technologies are better explained by an animation, an interactive visualization, or a well-made video than by any paragraph, and knowing how to find those explanations is a professional skill in its own right.
- **Collaboration.** Work in a small group the way lawyers actually work: divided tasks, internal deadlines, clear communication about working styles.

What This Project Builds

The Tech Digest serves two of the course goals listed on the course page: analyzing the technical architecture of computing systems and internet infrastructure, and communicating internet-law concepts clearly to diverse audiences. Completing it is part of the participation requirement in the syllabus's What Passing Requires box. It is completion-checked: done in good faith, with lateness recorded under the syllabus's late-work rule; never scored.

The Task: Four Components Over Three Weeks

1 · Read and Annotate the Technical Primer

Due: Wednesday, January 13, by 1:15 pm. Read the Chapter 1 technical primer (Grimmelmann 16th ed., pp. 13-43: computers, the internet, and cryptography). This posting is also your first annotation set, so one posting satisfies both; in Canvas it appears as two assignments with one due date (Session 1, pp. 13-24; Session 2, pp. 25-43), and together they are the one set. Write these notes without AI: generative AI is barred in every annotation set, this one included, though it may help you plan, outline, or refine the curation document. This component closes earlier than the rest: posted late, it counts until 1:15 pm on Wednesday, January 20 (Session 3); if you add the course after January 13, it is due by 1:15 pm on Monday, January 25, and is not late. As you read, leave the primer-variant annotation notes: paraphrase the dense passages in your own words, invent analogies a non-technical reader could follow, mark the fog where the material loses you, and pile on to classmates' threads; answering someone's fog note is peer teaching. Your annotations shape what I bring to class, and your group's best analogies will already be waiting there when the curation work begins.

2 • Join a Digest Group

Due: Sunday, January 17, by 10:00 pm. Join a Digest group in Canvas under People → Groups. It is the same sign-up mechanism your portfolio circle uses at the Session 6 sign-up, so learn it once here. Each group owns one slice of the primer. Group sizes and the number of groups per slice are set by the roster and posted with the sign-up:

- **Computers & data representation** (pp. 13-24)
- **Networks & the internet** (pp. 25-37)
- **Cryptography & security** (pp. 38-43)

Late adds are placed in a group at my discretion and take up whatever the group has left to do; the group's deadline stands. A group that loses members to drops continues with the same obligations, and I merge a group that falls below two.

3 • Curate Better Media, and Brief the Room

Document due: Wednesday, January 27, by 1:15 pm. Briefs in class the same day. With your group, find two or three media sources (videos, interactive tutorials, animations, simulators, podcasts) that teach your section's technology better than the textbook's text does, and say why the medium wins. For each source, write a 200-300 word evaluation covering:

- What technical concepts it explains effectively, and what makes its medium better suited to them than prose.
- Who created it, their credentials, who funds it, and whether the funding creates bias.
- Whether its technical claims can be verified against primary sources (RFCs, IEEE standards, technical documentation).
- Time to consume, accessibility (free, no account walls), and its limitations compared to the reading.
- How you found it: the search methods you used, so classmates can reuse them.

Then brief the room in class on January 27: show your best find, teach the room its core concept in lay terms, and make the case for the medium. Briefs share part of the period with the day's discussion; the length per group is announced with the group assignments, and runs about five minutes in a small class. Your group's document goes into the class's shared media library on Canvas, where it stays available all semester.

4 • Self and Peer Reflection

Due: Monday, February 1, by 11:59 pm. Complete the short self- and peer-reflection in Canvas (a text-entry assignment, Tech Digest 4): how your group divided the work, what you contributed, what you would do differently. Peer input tells me where to look; what I conclude about your own contribution is my judgment, and your reflection never scores a classmate.

If something is late. The syllabus's late-work rule applies: a late component counts if it is in by the project's close, the start of Session 9 (Wednesday, February 10), and is recorded as late, except the primer annotation, which closes at 1:15 pm on Wednesday, January 20; two or more late items across the term cost participation Honors. Nothing is accepted after the close, and a component not in by then leaves the project incomplete, which means the participation requirement is not met. If you miss the in-class brief, present at the start of the next class session; that is a late item. A late group submission is a late item for every member of the group: unlike your circle, where you are held harmless for a circle-mate's lapse, the Digest document is the group's.

Timeline

Due	Component	Where
Wed., Jan. 13, 1:15 pm	Primer read and annotated (pp. 13-43)	Hypothesis via Canvas
Sun., Jan. 17, 10:00 pm	Digest group joined	People → Groups
Wed., Jan. 27, 1:15 pm	Curation document; brief in class	Canvas and the classroom
Mon., Feb. 1, 11:59 pm	Self and peer reflection	Canvas text-entry assignment

WHAT COMPLETE LOOKS LIKE

The Tech Digest is complete when all four components are in by the project's close, the instructions above are followed, and your group's peer reflections show good-faith, roughly equitable contribution. A successful curation document recommends strong resources from credentialed sources, analyzes rather than summarizes them, makes a real argument for why each medium beats text for its concept, and is written so a first-week 1L could follow it. There are no points and no rankings. If something goes wrong, talk to me before the deadline, not after.

Collaboration Guidance

Your group decides how it works: shared documents for asynchronous drafting, a brief video check-in or two, tasks divided by strength, internal deadlines set ahead of the real ones. Have the working-styles conversation in your first exchange: who works early and who works at the deadline, who wants check-ins and who wants independence, how you will handle disagreement. You will have the same conversation again with your portfolio circle.

Course documents

Each link opens the current version: the Circle Guide from the shared course folder, every other document from the course website. The syllabus is the master document and controls where documents differ.

Syllabus. The master document; it controls where documents differ.

Circle Guide. How the portfolio works, from sign-up to circles, the Memo Rubric, the cure cycle, the CREAC template, and the Circle Letter form.

Memo Coversheet & Certification. The cover materials required with every memo.

Tech Digest Project (this document). Instructions and deadlines, from the first session to the reflection due February 1.

Annotation Guide. What goes in an annotation set.

SIAR Module. The Session 6 module and the quiz instructions.

Course website. The course home page: next class, deadlines, and links to every course document; the Unit Circles page is linked from it.

Shared course folder. Where the Circle Guide lives, always the current version.

Canvas course. Modules, assignments, sign-ups, the Session Make-Up Board, and recordings.

DOCUMENT HISTORY

OPEN IN v10.1 (unresolved items; each resolves in a numbered revision):

- Group sizes: set when the roster is known and posted with the sign-up.

v10.1 · Oct 19, 2026 · Course documents: every document but the Circle Guide now opens as a PDF from the course website; links updated; a stray link in the appendix removed; no rule changed.

Earlier versions are kept by the professor; the version above is the one in force.